CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

NANNY / FAMILY ASSISTANT (PRO) IN THE AI ERA

The $52K 'pro' tier is real. It just isn't hiring anyone without three years of proof — and every agency says so.

★ **TL;DR — NO — at entry. The pro segment medians ~$52K a year (INA survey), but every agency checked requires 3+ years of verifiable experience, so a beginner's actual door is direct hire at the childcare-worker median of ~$35K, in an occupation shrinking −2%. The roadmap below picks care work that trains and promotes beginners instead.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

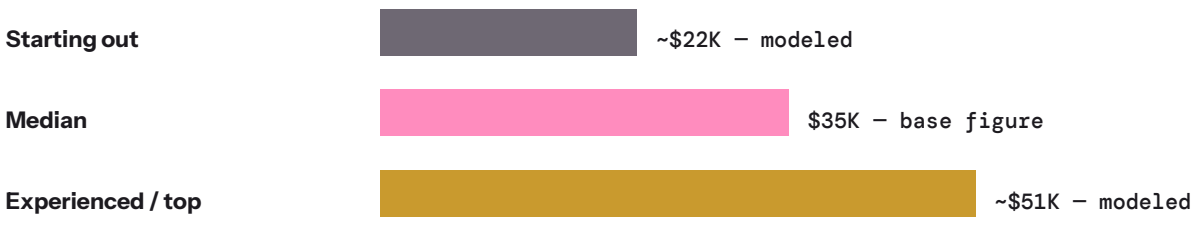
OUR TAKE: NO — NOT IN 2027

MEDIAN ~$35K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Two different jobs share this title: the agency 'pro' (~$52K annualised, experience-gated) and the beginner's direct-hire seat at the BLS childcare median of $34,980. The old $45K figure sat in the gap between them.
- No licence exists to speed you up: states don't regulate nannies, so the only currency is verifiable years — which a beginner by definition doesn't have.
- The occupation itself is shrinking (−2%, all ~150,300 yearly openings are replacements), on demographics and cost — not AI.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Nanny / Family Assistant (pro) is a ~$35K median (compiled from U.S. labor-market data (this title has no separate BLS occupation; the figure is a

market/anchor estimate)). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A NANNY / FAMILY ASSISTANT (PRO) ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Childcare, activities and developmental play through the day
- ✓ School runs, meals, homework and routines
- ✓ Household logistics: schedules, supplies, appointments
- ✓ Clear, proactive communication with the parents

Think: chief of staff for a small, emotional, snack-driven organization.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Scheduling apps, monitors and parent-messaging tools — admin only. No source found shows AI substituting in-home physical childcare.	Physical supervision, feeding, transport and safety inside a private home, plus the judgment calls no checklist covers. The demand headwind is birth rates, not software.

⚠ **PRINT BOTH NUMBERS, ALWAYS: the INA pro median (~$52K annualised from $25/hr) is a survey of working professionals with years in — it is not an offer a beginner receives. The beginner figure is the BLS childcare median, $34,980, with a bottom decile under $11.66/hr. Any card that shows you only the first number is selling you the second.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Kids and families — the same work you wanted ✓ Training paid by the employer, a credential in your name ✓ A team and a supervisor, not one household's mood	✗ Session-based pay can gap when clients cancel ✗ Emotionally intense days are the job ✗ Data logging follows every session

Good fit? Warm with children, unflappable, discreet — and ready to let a credential, not just a family's gratitude, carry your wage.
Bad fit? You need corporate structure, colleagues and a door you can close at five.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — PIVOT TO ABA THERAPIST (RBT)	DOOR B — PIVOT TO MEDICAL ASSISTANT
Care work with kids that hires beginners on purpose: ABA clinics routinely take zero-experience hires and pay for the 40-hour training and the RBT exam themselves. The seat's BLS proxy (psychiatric technicians and aides) medians $45,100 and grows +18%, powered by autism prevalence of 1 in 31 children and insurance mandates in all 50 states. First move: apply to ABA providers near you — 'no experience, training provided' is the normal ad, not the exception.	The other care door with a ladder attached: clinics hire beginners into a defined role with a credential, a wage scale and rungs above it, instead of one family's mood deciding your income. The skills transfer directly — children, families, routines, calm under pressure. First move: compare local medical-assistant programs and clinic trainee postings; many health systems hire and train while you certify.

Smart move: If you nanny now, bank the proof like a portfolio: written references, CPR and first aid, logged years with ages and duties. 'Verifiable' is the word agencies pay for — and the same record makes ABA and clinic hiring managers say yes faster.
Where you land after: A credentialed care role — RBT or a clinic seat — where experience raises your wage on a scale, instead of restarting at zero with every new family.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
PRICE THE	CHOOSE THE	START THE	COMPETENCY +	CARRY A	STEP UP

STEP 1 — Price the two doors honestly

FREE · TODAY

- Agency ads: 3+ years of verifiable experience, every time — that's the gate, not a preference
- Beginner reality: direct hire near the $34,980 childcare median; the $52K pro tier is a year-three-plus destination

STEP 2 — Choose the laddered care job

FREE · WEEK 1

- ABA providers: apply where training is paid and the RBT exam is covered
- Medical assisting: list clinic trainee roles and short programs as the parallel track

STEP 3 — Start the 40-hour training (ABA route)

WEEKS 1-6

- Complete the BACB 40-hour training — employers commonly provide it free
- Pass the background and abuse-registry checks

STEP 4 — Competency + exam

MONTHS 2-3

- Pass the initial competency assessment with your supervising clinician
- Sit the RBT exam — BACB and Pearson fees total $110, often covered by the employer

STEP 5 — Carry a supervised caseload

MONTHS 3-6

- Run 1:1 sessions from the clinician's plan; log data every session
- Protect your hours: ask how cancellations are paid before you sign anywhere

STEP 6 — Step up on the ladder

MONTHS 6-12

- Senior technician, lead RBT, or the graduate route toward BCBA over time
- Or take the record into medical assisting — two ladders now know your name

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: the agency requirement — 3+ years — written next to the $35K beginner median. Decide whether to wait for one or climb the other.

□ Days 1–30: applications in at ABA providers that pay for training; first interviews.

□ Days 31–60: the 40-hour training underway or done; background checks cleared.

□ Days 61–90: competency assessment passed or scheduled; exam date booked.

□ Day 90: you're a working technician on a ladder — your care experience is finally compounding instead of expiring with each family.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **CARE THAT COMPOUNDS.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. labor-market data (this title has no separate BLS occupation; the figure is a market/anchor estimate)). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.